Solar Surge Setter Playbook

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How to use this playbook

Every call has one job: book a fully qualified appointment the homeowner remembers and wants to keep. We don't have a lead problem. We lose deals because people don't recall us, don't respect the appointment, or don't qualify when the consultant arrives.

Every lead arrives pre-qualified by our call-centre vendor. So the setter's job isn't to interview from scratch. It's to verify what the vendor captured, fill any gaps, and build the relationship that makes the appointment stick. Read the vendor notes before you dial and use them as conversation starters ("I've got here that…"). Vendor notes are often incomplete or out of date, so every qualifier still gets confirmed in the homeowner's own words. If what they say differs from the notes, trust the homeowner and update the CRM.

The mindset: you are the owner, not the caller

- **Talk like you run the place.** Owners don't read scripts or rush. They're curious, calm, and happy to walk away from a bad fit. Use "we" and "our consultants", never "I've been told to".
- **Ask, then listen.** Aim for the homeowner talking 60% of the call. Every question below has a reason the homeowner benefits from, so say the reason.
- **Qualify to protect them, not you.** "I'd rather not waste your Thursday if it's not a fit" lands better than any pitch. Disqualifying out loud builds trust.
- **No prices, no ballparks.** "I'd be guessing, and a guess is worse than useless when it's your money."
- **Under 5 minutes.** If you're past 5, you're explaining. Stop and book.
- **Use the words in these scripts as a map, not a cage.** Learn the flow and the questions, then say them your way.
- **Urgency must be real.** Only name a suburb, a nearby appointment, or a deadline if it's true. A homeowner who catches one stretched fact cancels.

The six qualifiers (all six or it's not a booking)

Qualifier	What passes	How you get it in conversation
Homeowners, both present	Owner-occupied; every owner/decision-maker at the sit	"Who else looks after the bills with you?"
Bill size	$450+ per quarter or $150+ per month	"What's a typical bill looking like, monthly or quarterly?"
Shading	No major trees or structures shading the roof	"Any big trees around the house, especially on the north side?"

Qualifier	What passes	How you get it in conversation
Working status	Full-time, part-time or retired (noted)	"Are you both home during the day or out working?"
Staying put	Not selling or moving in the next 2–3 years	"Are you settled there for a while?"
Roof and insurance	Roof sound; no open insurance claim (unless cash settlement)	"How's the roof holding up? Any hail damage or insurance work going on?"

Servicing area is SEQ. For Toowoomba or Lismore, flag it with the team before you lock the time.

The call flow at a glance

1. **Pattern interrupt** (10 sec): break the "another sales call" reflex and earn 60 seconds.
2. **Memory anchor** (15 sec): tie this call to something they did or said, so they recall us.
3. **Consultative discovery** (2 min): the six qualifiers, asked as genuine curiosity.
4. **Reflect the problem** (20 sec): say their situation back in one sentence.
5. **Position the assessment** (30 sec): what they get, why it's worth an hour.
6. **Assumptive close** (30 sec): offer two specific times, never "when suits you?"
7. **Lock it in** (45 sec): confirm both owners and give them a reason to pick up next time.

One process change that fixes recall

Send a short text from your own mobile 2–5 minutes before the first call attempt. Example: "Hi Sarah, Liam from Solar Surge. You asked about batteries on Tuesday. I'll give you a quick buzz shortly, no pressure." A name and a reason on their screen doubles the chance they answer and remember you. Log the text in the CRM.

The setter script, with rebuttals built in

Pick the opener that matches the lead source. From Step 3 on, every call runs the same conversation. Each objection sits at the step where it usually comes up, so you handle it and carry on without losing your place. Lines in *italics* are notes for you, not words to say.

Handling any objection: Acknowledge, Reframe, Ask, Advance

An objection is a homeowner protecting their time or money. Never fight it.

1. **Acknowledge.** Show you heard it, in your own words. Not "I understand, but…". The "but" erases everything before it.
2. **Reframe.** Offer the homeowner's-eye view: what a smart owner in their position would want to know.
3. **Ask.** A question puts them back in the conversation and tells you what's really going on.
4. **Advance.** Return to the step you were on, or offer two times.

Two rules: handle each objection a maximum of twice, then let them go politely. And use "100%" sparingly. Said every time, it sounds scripted.

Step 1–2: Opener, pattern interrupt and memory anchor

The interrupt works because it's not what they expect. You're honest that it's a call about solar, you hand them control, and you prove you know who they are. Pause after the first line and let them answer.

Call Centre lead (CC)

> *"Hi [Name], it's Liam. Honest question before anything else: have I caught you at a terrible time, or just a mildly bad one?"*
>
> *(Let them laugh or answer.)*
>
> *"Fair enough, I'll be quick. I'm with Solar Surge. You had a chat with one of our team on [day] about your power bill and the solar you've already got. I've got their notes in front of me and I just wanted to check they got it right, because I don't like sending anyone out on bad info."*

Lead form / online enquiry (Lead AX)

> *"Hi [Name], it's Liam from Solar Surge. You filled in a form about solar and batteries on [day]. You've probably had five companies ring since, so I'll make mine the easiest call you take today."*
>
> *(Pause.)*
>
> *"I'm not going to quote you anything over the phone, because I'd just be guessing. I just want to understand your setup so I know whether we're even worth your time. Fair?"*

Door-to-door lead (D2D)

> *"Hi [Name], it's Liam from Solar Surge. [D2D rep name] knocked on your door on [day], the [describe them, e.g. tall guy in the navy polo]. He said you were great to chat to and left me a couple of notes."*
>
> *"He mentioned [one detail they said, e.g. the bills jumped after the kids moved back home]. Did I read that right?"*

If they say: "I'm at work, can't talk"

Usually means: "I don't know if this is worth my time."

> *"Say no more, I'll be 20 seconds. Just so I know it's even worth calling you back: roughly what's your power bill sitting at?"*

If they answer, go straight into Step 3. If they shut down again:

> *"All good. We've got consultants around [suburb] on [day] doing free assessments. What time are you usually home, so I ring you then and not in the middle of work again?"*

Book a specific call-back time, not "later".

If they say: "I don't remember speaking to anyone" / "I didn't fill in any form"

Usually means: "I'm suspicious." Don't argue about whether they enquired.

> *"That's fair, you probably get a lot of these. It came through on [day] about solar and batteries for [street name]. Could've been someone else in the house. Either way, I won't take more than two minutes. Can I ask, have you got panels up there already?"*

If they say: "Is this a scam? How did you get my number?"

> *"Good on you for asking, you should. I'm Liam, Solar Surge, based in [location]. Your details came from [the enquiry form / our door-knock on (day) / our call on (day)]. I'll text you my name and our website right now so you can check us out. If you don't want a call again, just say and I'll take you off."*

If they ask to be removed: remove them, no rebuttal.

If they say: "Not interested"

Usually means: "I've been burnt", "I think it's expensive", or "bad timing". Find out which.

> *"No problem at all, and I'm not here to change your mind. Can I ask, is it more that you've looked into it and it didn't stack up, or just not the right time?"*

If "didn't stack up":

> *"That's a common one, honestly. Things have moved a lot with the battery rebates. Out of curiosity, what's the bill looking like at the moment?"*

If the bill is low: "Good on you, that's a well-run house. Are you on one of the old 44c feed-in tariffs? A lot of people don't realise when theirs ends." *(Confirm the current end date with your manager before quoting it.) Once they're talking, move into Step 3.*

Step 3: Verify and deepen (confirm the vendor's notes, as conversation)

The vendor has already asked these, so don't re-ask cold. Read their answer back as a statement and let the homeowner confirm or correct it. This feels like a consultant who did their homework, not a second interview. Then go one layer deeper with a follow-up the vendor didn't ask. Order is flexible; tick each one off in the CRM as you go.

Their current setup and bill

> *"So I've got here you've got solar up there already. How long's that been on? Did you put it in, or was it there when you moved in?"*

"Was it there when you moved in" quietly tells you how long they've owned, and whether they own at all.

> *"The notes say your bill's sitting around $[vendor figure] a quarter. Still about right, or has it crept up?"*

- *If $450+/qtr or $150+/month:* "Still a decent bill with panels up there. Is that a big family, pool, aircon, or a bit of everything?"

- *If low:* "That's actually pretty good. Are you on one of the older 44c feed-in tariffs?" *(If yes:)* "Do you know when yours finishes? That's the one a lot of people are getting caught out by, because the bill jumps the quarter after it ends." *Also ask:* "Any plans for an EV, a spa, or a pool down the track?" *Future usage can still make the appointment worthwhile, but it must clear the bill minimum to book.*

If they say: "Solar's a scam, it hasn't helped my bill"

They're frustrated. Agree and diagnose.

> *"You're not the first person to say that, and honestly, a lot of systems were sold badly. Let me ask: is the house mostly using power at night, once the sun's gone?"*
>
> *"That's usually it. Your panels make power when nobody's home and you sell it back for a few cents, then buy it back at night for 30-plus. That's the gap a battery's designed to close. It might not suit you, and the consultant will tell you if it doesn't. Worth finding out properly?"*

Daytime use and working status

> *"Are you both out working during the day, or is someone home a fair bit?"*

Tie it back: "That's usually why the bill stays high even with panels. You make power when nobody's home and buy it back at night."

Decision-makers

> *"I've got you and [partner] down as the owners. Is it the two of you who look after the bills together?"*

Staying put

> *"And you mentioned you're settled there for a while. Still the plan for the next couple of years?"*

Reason, if they ask: "Solar pays back over years, so if you're selling soon I'd honestly tell you not to bother."

Roof and shading

> *"Roof's in good nick from what I've got here? No hail damage or insurance work going on?"*
>
> *"And any big trees around the house, especially on the north side?"*

Awareness (optional, builds value)

> *"Have you seen much about the battery rebates at the moment?"*

Listen. Don't explain them in detail. That's the consultant's job.

If they say: "I've already had quotes" / "Spoke to another company"

This is good news. They're in the market.

> *"Smart, you should get a few. How did they compare? Anything that didn't sit right with you?"*
>
> *"Part of what our consultant does is walk you through what to look out for: the panels, the battery brands, the warranty fine print. Even if you go with someone else, you'll know your quote is a good one. Worth an hour?"*

If a qualifier fails: disqualify gracefully

These protect the consultant's time and our QSP numbers. End warmly. A disqualified homeowner can still refer a neighbour.

- **Renting:** "Ah, it'd be the owner's call then. If you want, pass on our name."
- **Selling or moving in 2–3 years:** "Honestly, I'd hold off. You wouldn't get the full benefit. Give us a shout when you're settled in the next place."
- **Open insurance claim or roof replacement pending (not cash settlement):** "Let's get the roof sorted first, otherwise we'd be putting panels on something that's about to change. When's the work due?" *Diary a call-back for then.*
- **Bill below minimum, no future usage plans:** "Your bill's honestly in good shape. I don't think we'd save you enough to be worth an hour."

Step 4: Reflect the problem back

One sentence in their words. This is where they decide you understand them.

> *"So if I've got this right: you've had panels for about six years, you're both at work all day, and you're still paying around $600 a quarter mostly from night-time use. That about sum it up?"*

Step 5: Position the assessment

> *"Here's what I'd suggest. One of our senior consultants sits down with you both for 45 minutes to an hour. They look at the roof, the switchboard and a couple of recent bills, and work out whether a battery or an upgrade would actually reduce that bill, or whether you're better off leaving it alone."*
>
> *"You'll get a proper design and a written quote based on your numbers, not a one-size-fits-all price. What you do with it is entirely up to you. Even if you never go with us, you'll know exactly where you stand."*

If they say: "Just give me a price over the phone"

Usually means: "I don't want a salesperson in my house."

> *"I'd love to, but I'd be making it up. Any company giving you a firm price without seeing your roof, switchboard and bills is giving you a guess, and the guess usually goes up on install day. That's the exact mistake we try to help people avoid."*

> *"The consultant comes out, does the numbers properly, and leaves it in writing. No pressure on the day. Does [day] at 4:30 or 6:00 work better?"*

If they say: "Just send me some information" / "Email me"

Usually means: a polite no.

> *"Happy to. The honest problem is a brochure can't tell you what your house needs, so it'll just be generic. What's the one thing you'd want it to answer?"*

Answer it briefly, then: "That's exactly what the assessment works out. Rather than you reading something generic, I can have [consultant] show you your own numbers on [day]."

If they say: "Can't afford it" / "Money's tight"

> *"Totally fair, and I'd never want anyone stretching for this. That's the funny part: you're already paying for power every quarter. The assessment just looks at whether that money could be working for you instead of going to the retailer. If it doesn't stack up, the consultant will say so."*

If they say: "I'm waiting for prices to drop / better batteries"

> *"Makes sense, tech always gets better. The question is what waiting costs you. At $[their bill] a quarter, that's about $[bill × 4] a year going to the retailer while you wait. The consultant can show you both sides: do it now or wait, on your numbers."*

Step 6: Assumptive close (suggest, never ask)

Offer two specific times close together. Choose times when both owners are home, based on what they told you about work.

> *"[Consultant name] is doing assessments around [suburb] on [day]. Seeing as you're both working, I can hold 4:30 or 6:00 that evening. Which is easier for you and [partner]?"*

Only mention a nearby appointment if it's real. If it is: "He's already seeing a family a few streets over that afternoon, so I can slot you straight after."

If neither time works: "No worries. What's [partner]'s finishing time on a weekday?" *Then offer two new specific times.*

If they say: "I need to talk to my partner"

Good. We need them anyway.

> *"Perfect, that's exactly right. We only book when you're both there anyway, since it's both your money and your power habits. What's [partner]'s week like, are they working 9 to 5?"*
>
> *"Let me pencil in [day] at 6:00 so you've got something to check against. Run it past [partner] tonight and I'll call you tomorrow at [time] to lock it in or move it."*

If they say: "She/he won't be there, I handle this stuff" (the one-legger)

> *"Totally get it, someone always runs point on the house stuff. The thing is, we're sizing the system off how both of you use power: who's home, who runs the aircon, the late-night washing. If we miss half the picture we design it wrong, and that's your money."*
>
> *"It's also a big decision, and I'd hate you to be the one explaining it all second-hand later. Could you get [partner] to sit in for the hour? I can make it [6:00] so it suits them."*

If they flatly refuse: do not book. Offer a time that suits both or a call-back.

If they say: "I won't have time for at least a month"

> *"Fair enough, it's a busy time. The only reason I'd push for sooner is [consultant] is in [suburb] this week, and rebate settings do change. It's an hour, and evenings work. If I could make it 6:00 on [day], would that be doable?"*

Only cite timing or rebate pressure that is true. If not, book the earliest real slot in their window and diary a call-back.

Step 7: Lock it in

> *"Done, I've got you both down for [day] at [time]. Just so it's worth [consultant]'s drive and your hour: that's you and [partner] both there for the full hour?"*
>
> *"Perfect. Grab a recent bill if you can, it makes the numbers far more accurate."*
>
> *"I'll text you now from this number with [consultant]'s name, so you know who's knocking. Someone from our team will give you a quick ring the day before to make sure it all still works. Save this number as Solar Surge so you know it's us."*
>
> *"Anything you'd like [consultant] to look at specifically while he's there?"*

The last question gives them ownership of the appointment. Write their answer in the CRM notes so the consultant can use it.

Step 8: Log the booking

Log it before you take your next call. Detailed notes mean anyone who calls this homeowner next, and the consultant at the door, can pick up exactly where you left off.

- ☐ Day and time booked, consultant assigned
- ☐ Both owners' full names, and who you spoke to
- ☐ Bill amount in their words, and the main driver (pool, aircon, kids, night usage)
- ☐ Existing solar: age, size if known, feed-in tariff if mentioned
- ☐ All six qualifiers ticked, with any answer that differed from the vendor notes flagged
- ☐ Working status, and pension type and over/under 65 if retired
- ☐ Objections raised on the call and how they landed
- ☐ The one thing they want the consultant to look at
- ☐ One personal detail to open with (new baby, just back from holiday, renovating)

- ☐ Pre-call text sent, and the number used

Quick-reference card for the floor

Keep this beside you. Learn the full scripts above in training. On the call, this is all you need.

The flow: Interrupt → Anchor → Discover → Reflect → Position → Two times → Lock it in

The method for any objection: Acknowledge → Reframe → Ask → Advance (twice max)

Objection	Your one-liner
At work	"20 seconds. Roughly what's the bill sitting at?"
Don't remember	"Fair enough. It came through on [day] for [street]. Got panels up there already?"
Not interested	"Not here to change your mind. Is it that it didn't stack up, or just timing?"
Price over the phone	"I'd be guessing, and guesses go up on install day."
Already got quotes	"Smart. Anything that didn't sit right with you?"
Send me info	"A brochure can't tell you what your house needs. What would you want it to answer?"
Talk to my partner	"Perfect, we need you both anyway. I'll pencil 6:00 and call tomorrow to lock it."
Partner won't come	"We size it off both your habits. Miss half and we design it wrong."
No time for a month	"It's an hour, evenings work. Could 6:00 on [day] be doable?"
Solar's a scam	"A lot were sold badly. Is the house mostly using power at night?"
Can't afford it	"You're already paying for power. This checks if it can work for you."
Waiting for better tech	"What does waiting cost? About $[bill × 4] a year."
Is this a scam?	"Good on you for asking. I'll text you my name and our website now."

Never: quote prices or ballparks, book a one-legger, stretch the truth on urgency, or ask "when's a good time?"

Always: text before the first call, use their details back to them, offer two specific times, and log the one thing they want the consultant to look at.

Open item for management: confirm the current end date of the 44c feed-in tariff before any rep uses it as a reason to act.